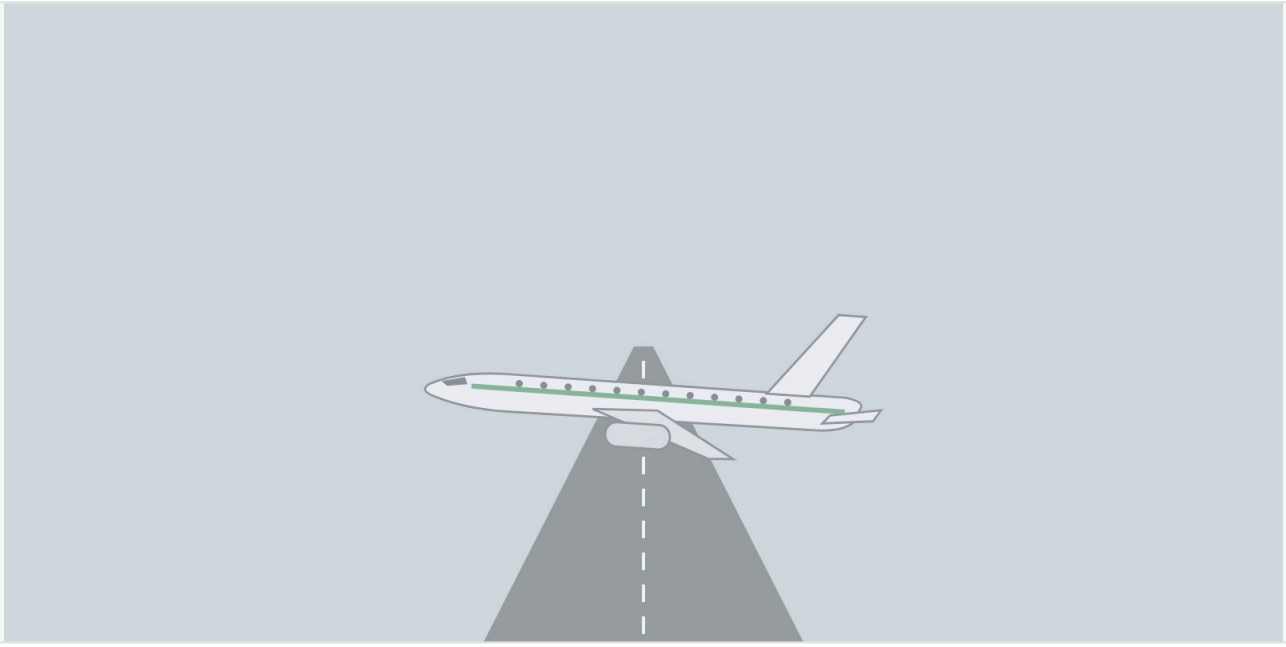
MODULE 1 · APPROACH OPERATIONS

Lesson 04: Low-Visibility Operations Overview

Lesson 4 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Describe the requirements for CAT II and CAT III operations.
- Explain low-visibility procedures at aerodromes.
- Recognise when LVO capability is lost.



CAT II and III need a specific approval.

Requirements

- A **specific approval** (SPA.LVO) for the operator, with the aircraft certified, the crew trained and qualified, and procedures in the Operations Manual.
- The aerodrome with **low-visibility procedures (LVP)** in force, and the required ground equipment serviceable.
- The aircraft equipment required for the category serviceable — check the MEL and the AFM.

Low-visibility procedures

When LVP are in force, ATC protects the ILS sensitive and critical areas, increases spacing and uses specific taxi routes. Low-visibility take-off (LVTO) below the standard take-off minima also needs approval and suitable runway lighting.

Loss of capability

- Aircraft failures (autopilot channels, autothrottle, displays) can downgrade the approach category — the FCOM / AOM gives the effect.

- Ground equipment failures can also raise the minima — see the next course on inoperative ground equipment.
- Fog: know the types (radiation, advection) and their trends for planning.

COMPANY AUTHORISATION

The approach operations each fleet is authorised for — for example CAT I only, or CAT II for a fleet and crew with the approval — are listed in the **AOC operations specifications** issued by the **DACM**. The method and values for minima are in **OM A**; the aerodrome minima are in **OM C** and the charts.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- CAT II / III: approval, aircraft, crew, procedures, aerodrome LVP and equipment.
- LVP protect ILS areas and increase spacing.
- Aircraft or ground failures can downgrade the category.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Which is NOT required to fly a CAT II approach?

A. Operator specific approval

B. LVP in force at the aerodrome

C. Trained and qualified crew

D. A weather radar image of the fog

Answer: D. A weather radar image is not a requirement.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.